



policies, while also ensuring diversification in the sector. Participants also explored the potential of the survey exercise paving the way to establishing a Tourism Satellite Account — a globally recognised framework for assessing the true economic impact of tourism.

Matthew Duckworth, Australian High Commissioner to Sri Lanka, said, “Australia has been a steadfast partner in supporting Sri Lanka’s economic growth, particularly in tourism. Through MDF, we’ve worked alongside Sri Lanka’s tourism authority to strengthen evidence-based planning, enhance research capacity and promote sustainability. This partnership is a testament to Australia’s commitment to helping Sri Lanka build a thriving and resilient tourism industry, rooted in real evidence. Australia is pleased to extend additional support to the Government of Sri Lanka to help position the country as a world-renowned sustainable tourism destination. This includes strengthening promotional efforts and exploring how data can improve the targeting and impact of Sri Lanka’s global tourism promotion campaigns. In addition, Australia will support Sri Lanka to uphold international standards of environmental protection, reinforcing its reputation as a global leader in sustainable tourism.”

Buddhika Hewawasam, Chairman, Sri Lanka Tourism Development Authority, noted that, “Our partnership with Australia’s MDF has been instrumental in elevating how we collect, analyse, and use data. From research training to large-scale surveys, MDF’s support has empowered SLTDA to make more informed decisions and to plan for a future where data leads strategy. This is an important step toward a tourism sector built on transparency, innovation, and measurable impact.”

The event featured a panel discussion titled, “Turning Data into Direction: Shaping Tourism Together,” which brought together

key government and industry stakeholders to discuss how accurate data can bridge the gap between research and decision-making.



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